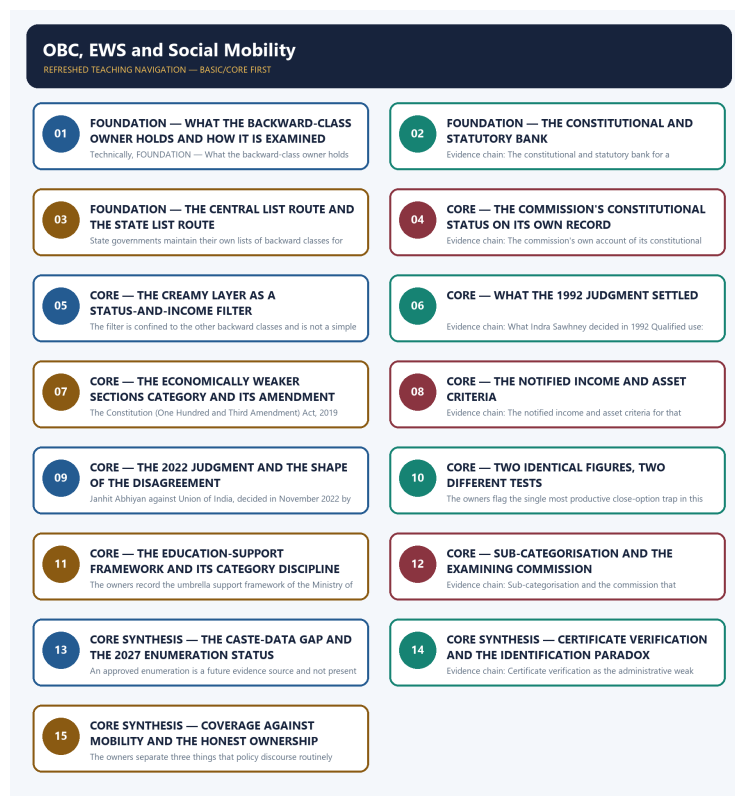


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

OBC, EWS and Social Mobility - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. C. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. D. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

Answer: A. Explanation: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: B. Explanation: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. C. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. D. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

Answer: C. Explanation: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. C. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. D. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

Answer: D. Explanation: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer?

A. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

C. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

D. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer?

A. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading

had removed. B. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. C. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. D. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is

asserted. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer?

A. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. B. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. C. *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. D. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the

backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The Central List route under Article 342A?

A. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

Answer: A. Explanation: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under The Central List route under Article 342A?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. D. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

Answer: B. Explanation: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Central List route under Article 342A?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. C. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the

socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. D. *Indra Sawhney against Union of India*, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: C. Explanation: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Central List route under Article 342A?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney against Union of India* and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. *Indra Sawhney against Union of India*, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: D. Explanation: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution

inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment?

A. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. B. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. C. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. D. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

Answer: A. Explanation: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment?

A. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. B. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. C. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: B. Explanation: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the

present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.

Answer: C. Explanation: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment?

A. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. B. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. C. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. D. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

Answer: D. Explanation: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The commission's own account of its constitutional status?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. C. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The commission's own account of its constitutional status?

A. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. C. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The commission's own account of its constitutional status?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019

inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The commission's own account of its constitutional status?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure

when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test?

A. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. B. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a

quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test?

A. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. B. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test?

A. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. B. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed

test. C. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an

other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not

violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. C. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. D. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes?

A. *Janhit Abhiyan* against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. B. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. C. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. D. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to

assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies What *Indra Sawhney* decided in 1992?

A. *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. *Janhit Abhiyan* against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

Answer: A. Explanation: *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. C. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992?

A. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services

and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: C. Explanation: Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992?

A. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: D. Explanation: Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it

fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment?

A. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment?

A. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public

employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment?

A. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and

post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The notified income and asset criteria for that category?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The notified income and asset criteria for that category?

A. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. B. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed

test. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The notified income and asset criteria for that category?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. C. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. D. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft

or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The notified income and asset criteria for that category?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement?

A. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to

examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement?

A. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. B. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category

are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: B. Explanation: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement?

A. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement?

A. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: D. Explanation: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests?

A. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that

the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests?

A. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically

weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. D. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests?

A. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. B. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges:

coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students?

A. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions

match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. C. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. D. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students?

A. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. B. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document

income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it?

A. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it?

A. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D

rotation. C. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. D. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which

sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. C. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025

General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim

about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status?

A. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status?

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions,

evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status?

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. B. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent

for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category?

A. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. B. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. C. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or

Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. D. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. D. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility?

A. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. B. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of

beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. D. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second

Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. C. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of

backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility?

A. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. The owners record the law book precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in

minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. C. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. D. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback?

A. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. B. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. C. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather

than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. D. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary

proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The transparent ownership statement for this owner?

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The transparent ownership statement for this owner?

A. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The transparent ownership statement for this owner?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The transparent ownership statement for this owner?

A. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

The audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and that zero is reported openly rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card. The four audited ledgers consulted are the Mains routing ledgers for 2018 to 2023 and for 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims routing ledgers for 2018 to 2023 and for 2024 to 2025, and neither the Basic owner nor the Advanced owner for this topic carries a generated previous-year integration block, which is itself consistent with that zero. Both owners state independently that there is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question specifically on the other backward classes or the economically weaker sections in the audited local previous-year texts, and this package adopts exactly that position. The two nearest neighbouring demands are the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from a statutory to a constitutional body, and the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes both to the Polity commissions owner together with the consolidated body-design owner, so no ownership is claimed over either here; reservation doctrine such as the ordinary fifty per cent ceiling and the constitutional validity reasoning for the economic criterion is likewise routed to the Polity special-provisions owner and is cross-linked rather than duplicated. The practice in this package therefore consists of six original Mains questions with model solutions, each written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern, together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. Each model solution opens with its analytical claim so that the evidence which follows does argumentative rather than decorative work. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm that no question on this owner's subject matter is routed here; no question was invented from them, no marking scheme or page precision was imported and no official answer key is claimed for any question anywhere in this package.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT".

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Define the vulnerable group, deprivation, right or policy concept and distinguish the nearest legal and measured category. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, judicial or executive basis and the competent Union, state or local institution. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Map rights-holder, household/community context, duty-bearer, frontline worker, provider and accountability forum. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Trace identification, eligibility, documentation, finance, access, portability, grievance, appeal and correction. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal

limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, judgment, scheme, institution or official dataset with source, date, denominator and status. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test intersectionality, regional variation, stigma, accessibility, privacy, fiscal adequacy, exclusion and causal limits. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: There is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 GS-II Mains PYQ specifically on OBC/EWS

in the audited local PYQ texts. However, the topic intersects with broader social-justice and reservation questions. A strong Mains answer should distinguish OBC (social-educational backwardness) from EWS (economic backwardness), explain the creamy-layer rationale, cite the 2022 Janhit Abhiyan judgment for EWS, and link reservation to social-mobility outcomes.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: There is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 GS-II Mains PYQ specifically on OBC/EWS

in the audited local PYQ texts. A strong Mains answer should: (a) distinguish social-educational backwardness (OBC) from economic backwardness (EWS), (b) explain the creamy-layer rationale and its limitations, (c) cite Janhit Abhiyan (2022) for EWS constitutional validity, (d) note the caste-data gap and the 2027 Census decision, and (e) frame reservation as a means to social mobility, not an end in itself.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish reservation for the other backward classes from reservation for the economically weaker sections with reference to their constitutional basis and identification criteria. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The two routes rest on different enabling provisions and different tests, so the distinction must name Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) against Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), then show that social and educational backwardness and a notified income-and-asset test are not interchangeable evidence.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.
- The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.
- The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.
- The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Qualified conclusion: The two routes rest on different enabling provisions and different tests, so the distinction must name Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) against Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), then show that social and educational backwardness and a notified income-and-asset test are not interchangeable evidence.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish reservation for the other backward classes from reservation for the economically...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The two routes rest on different enabling provisions and different tests, so the distinction must name Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) against Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), then show that social and educational backwardness and a notified income-and-asset test are not interchangeable evidence.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The two routes rest on different enabling provisions and different tests, so the distinction must name Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) against Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), then show that social and educational backwardness and a notified income-and-asset test are not interchangeable evidence.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish reservation for the other backward classes from reservation for the economically...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the rationale of the creamy-layer exclusion within backward-class reservation and examine its limitations. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The exclusion exists to stop repeated capture by the already advanced inside a listed category, so the explanation must state its status limb before its income limb and then locate its limits in threshold lag and in the absence of any comparable filter elsewhere.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.
- The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category.
- Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.
- The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Qualified conclusion: The exclusion exists to stop repeated capture by the already advanced inside a listed category, so the explanation must state its status limb before its income limb and then locate its limits in threshold lag and in the absence of any comparable filter elsewhere.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the rationale of the creamy-layer exclusion within backward-class reservation and...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction,

rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The exclusion exists to stop repeated capture by the already advanced inside a listed category, so the explanation must state its status limb before its income limb and then locate its limits in threshold lag and in the absence of any comparable filter elsewhere.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity,

remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The exclusion exists to stop repeated capture by the already advanced inside a listed category, so the explanation must state its status limb before its income limb and then locate its limits in threshold lag and in the absence of any comparable filter elsewhere.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the rationale of the creamy-layer exclusion within backward-class reservation and...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Critically examine the claim that the absence of published caste data undermines evidence-based backward-class policy. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The gap bites on calibration rather than on entitlement, so the examination must separate what cannot be computed without a dataset from what remains constitutionally secure with one, and must treat the forthcoming enumeration as a future source and not as present evidence.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.
- The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.
- The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.
- Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

Qualified conclusion: The gap bites on calibration rather than on entitlement, so the examination must separate what cannot be computed without a dataset from what remains constitutionally secure with one, and must treat the forthcoming enumeration as a future source and not as present evidence.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on "Critically examine the claim that the absence of published caste data undermines evidence-...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The gap bites on calibration rather than on entitlement, so the examination must separate what cannot be computed without a dataset from what remains constitutionally secure with one, and must treat the forthcoming enumeration as a future source and not as present evidence.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility,

dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The gap bites on calibration rather than on entitlement, so the examination must separate what cannot be computed without a dataset from what remains constitutionally secure with one, and must treat the forthcoming enumeration as a future source and not as present evidence.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Critically examine the claim that the absence of published caste data undermines evidence-...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the constitutional reasoning by which reservation on a purely economic criterion was upheld in 2022 and the objections it left open. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: A three-to-two majority is an argument and not a consensus, so the assessment must state the majority reasoning on a new category and the ceiling, state the dissent on substantive equality, and tie both to the exact notified test that was before the Court.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.
- Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.
- The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.
- The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also

stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Qualified conclusion: A three-to-two majority is an argument and not a consensus, so the assessment must state the majority reasoning on a new category and the ceiling, state the dissent on substantive equality, and tie both to the exact notified test that was before the Court.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the constitutional reasoning by which reservation on a purely economic criterion was...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: A three-to-two majority is an argument and not a consensus, so the assessment must state the majority reasoning on a new category and the ceiling, state the dissent on substantive equality, and tie both to the exact notified test that was before the Court.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done

so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: A three-to-two majority is an argument and not a consensus, so the assessment must state the majority reasoning on a new category and the ceiling, state the dissent on substantive equality, and tie both to the exact notified test that was before the Court.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the constitutional reasoning by which reservation on a purely economic criterion was...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse why reservation and scholarship coverage is an inadequate measure of social mobility, and what a better measurement architecture would require. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Coverage counts an administrative event while mobility is a cohort outcome, so the analysis must separate coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational progression, then specify the data, the unit and the time horizon that a mobility measure actually needs.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.
- The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

- The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.
- The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

Qualified conclusion: Coverage counts an administrative event while mobility is a cohort outcome, so the analysis must separate coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational progression, then specify the data, the unit and the time horizon that a mobility measure actually needs.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on "Analyse why reservation and scholarship coverage is an inadequate measure of social mobility,...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Coverage counts an administrative event while mobility is a cohort outcome, so the analysis must separate coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational progression, then specify the data, the unit and the time horizon that a mobility measure actually needs.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.
Analysis: Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions,

evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Coverage counts an administrative event while mobility is a cohort outcome, so the analysis must separate coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational progression, then specify the data, the unit and the time horizon that a mobility measure actually needs.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Analyse why reservation and scholarship coverage is an inadequate measure of social mobility,...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the proposition that backward-class policy in India has solved identification but not distribution. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Identification and distribution are different problems with different instruments, so the evaluation must show that the list-making route is settled while the division of the quota inside the category is not, and must close with a graded verdict that is honest about the missing evidence.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

- State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.
- Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.
- The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Qualified conclusion: Identification and distribution are different problems with different instruments, so the evaluation must show that the list-making route is settled while the division of the quota inside the category is not, and must close with a graded verdict that is honest about the missing evidence.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate the proposition that backward-class policy in India has solved identification but...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Identification and distribution are different problems with different instruments, so the evaluation must show that the list-making route is settled while the division of the quota inside the category is not, and must close with a graded verdict that is honest about the missing evidence.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. **Analysis:** Connect right or

deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Identification and distribution are different problems with different instruments, so the evaluation must show that the list-making route is settled while the division of the quota inside the category is not, and must close with a graded verdict that is honest about the missing evidence.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate the proposition that backward-class policy in India has solved identification but...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.